

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient is presenting with symptoms of depressed mood, hopelessness, difficulty making decisions, worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, and loss of energy and concentration. These symptoms have been present for a long time, and the patient feels that negative events are likely to occur, which is a characteristic known as "neuroticism" or "negative thinking style." However, the presence of worsening symptoms over the past 2 weeks, particularly the increase in suicidal ideations, guilt, and loss of energy and concentration, suggest an episode of depression. There is no mention of symptoms that are characteristic of mania or psychosis, such as elevated mood, grandiosity, or disorganized thinking. Additionally, there is no information to suggest that the patient is at risk for "double depression," which is a term used to describe the co-occurrence of major depressive episode and dysthymia. Paranoid personality disorder is a personality disorder characterized by a pervasive distrust and suspiciousness of others, which is not evident in this patient's presentation. Anhedonia, or the inability to feel pleasure, is a common symptom of depression and is consistent with the patient's reported loss of energy and concentration. </think> <answer> C. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder. </answer>